

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5

♥ K Q T 8 7 6 3

♦ 8 2

♣ T 9

♠ A J T 4

♥ J

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 7 6

♥ 5

♦ A J T 4

♣ J 8 5 3

♠ K 3 2

♥ A 9 4 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ K Q 6

West

3♥

All Pass

3♠ by South

North

Dbl

East

Pass

South

3♠

You dealt this hand.

You make a simple 3♥ opening bid and then the fireworks start. North doubles, your partner passes and South bids 3♠.

Do not preempt the same hand twice. The idea of a preemptive bid is that you bid it's maximum at your first turn. If there is to any further competing on this hand partner will have to do it.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K Q J 9 5

♥ Q 9 3

♦ 5 2

♣ J 6

♠ 8 6 3 2

♥ K 8

♦ A 9 6 4

♣ A 7 3



♠ T 7

♥ A J T 7 4

♦ -

♣ K Q T 9 4 2

♠ 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J T 8 7 3

♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

4 ♦

3 ♦

All Pass

4 ♦ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You do not have the 4 fast winners you need to raise partner to the 4-level. But you do have 4 of his trumps and 2 and a half winners. And your side doesn't have much defense against a 3 ♠ contract. You should raise partner to 4 ♦ because you think they can make 3 ♠. With these hands it appears they might have gone to 4 ♠ in which case you would have had to decide whether to continue to 5 ♦. More judgement would be called for, based on Vulnerability, whether you think they can make the game, etc. The Law of Total Tricks can be a help in these competitive situations; it would lead you to 5 ♦.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5

♥ 6

♦ A Q T 8 7 6 3

♣ T 9 5

♠ J 7 6 2

♥ A Q 9 3 2

◆ K 5

♣ A 8

♠ A 8

♥ 8 7 4

♦ J 9 4 2

♣ K 6 3 2

♠ K Q T 4 3

♥ K J T 5

◆ —

♣ Q J 7 4

West

3♦

All Pass

4♥ by South

North

Dbl

East

4♦

South

4♥

You dealt this hand.

You open 3♦. North doubles, partner raises to 4♦, and South bids 4♥.

You just pass. Partner's raise was probably just advancing your preempt and they got to 4♥ anyway. Sometimes preempts don't do the full job.

It is partner's decision, not yours, whether to continue to 5♦ as a sacrifice.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q T

♥ K T 7 5

♦ 9 3

♣ T 6 4

♠ 9 6 4

♥ -

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ A K Q J 8 3



♠ J 7 2

♥ 6 2

♦ A K Q J

♣ 9 7 5 2

♠ 8 5 3

♥ A Q J 9 8 4 3

♦ T 7 6

♣ -

West

North

East

South

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

The guidelines in the summary would have you bid 4♥. After all you very clearly have four quick winners.

But you also have seven quick losers in the other suits, and a trump void to boot.

Somewhere in some of these lessons there should be a guideline that says:

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 2
♥ 9 7 2
♦ A 9 3
♣ A 8 4 3

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 8 3

♦ Q 7 6 5

♣ K Q 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J

♥ K Q T 5 4

♦ K J T 2

♣ J 7 6

♠ A K T 8 7 6 3

♥ 6

♦ 8 4

♣ T 9 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

The fact that East opened doesn't change your hand at all. You had planned on **Opening 3 ♠**, now you make a **Weak Jump Overcall** of 3 ♠. If partner has some "stuff" you might get to a makeable contract, and if he doesn't you may keep the opponents out of a ♥ game.

This time everybody passes.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5 4 3
♥ 8 3
♦ K Q 9 7 6 3
♣ 3

♠ A K 7 2

♥ Q 7

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ A 9 5



♠ J T 8 6

♥ A 5

♦ J

♣ K Q J T 8 2

♠ Q

♥ K J T 9 6 4 2

♦ T 8

♣ 7 6 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You have four quick winners. If partner had opened 3 ♥ you would have bid 4 ♥ in the blink of an eye. His Weak Jump Overcall describes the exact same hand. So blink and bid 4 ♥.